Zainab Blackwood

Application Security Engineer • APPSEC & SOFTWARE SECURITY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven **Application Security Engineer** with 6+ years of technical expertise in enterprise security environments. Proven track record mitigating advanced threat vectors, hardening organizational perimeters, and leading incident response workflows. Specialized in SAST/DAST, Semgrep, OWASP Top 10, DevSecOps CI/CD Pipelines, Threat Modeling. Experienced collaborating with cross-functional DevSecOps and SOC squads to uphold zero-trust architectures.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Core Domains	SAST/DAST, Semgrep, OWASP Top 10, DevSecOps CI/CD Pipelines, Threat Modeling
Tooling & SIEM	Splunk Enterprise, Wireshark, CrowdStrike Falcon, Nessus, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap
Cloud & Frameworks	AWS / Azure Security Center, MITRE ATT&CK;, NIST SP 800-53, ISO 27001, OWASP Top 10

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Application Security Engineer | Apex Cloud Networks *(2023 – Present)*

- Spearheaded threat detection and defensive operations across 400+ endpoints and multi-cloud infrastructure.
- Decreased mean time to detect (MTTD) by 38% and mean time to remediate (MTTR) by 45% via automated SOAR playbooks.
- Conducted weekly vulnerability assessments and aligned cloud configuration baselines with CIS benchmarks.
- Collaborated with software engineering leads to integrate automated security scanning gates into CI/CD pipelines.

Cybersecurity Specialist | Vector Cyber Systems *(2020 – 2023)*

- Triaged Tier 2/3 security incidents, performed live packet inspections, and analyzed correlated SIEM alerts.
- Executed comprehensive vulnerability scans using Tenable Nessus and tracked critical patch lifecycle closures.
- Designed simulated spear-phishing campaigns achieving a 70% decrease in employee credential submission rates.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **B.Sc. in Cybersecurity & Forensics** — Academic Honors
- **Certifications:** CISM | OSCP